

Drawings in, ETABS model out

A tool that turns the drawings we already issue into the ETABS model an engineer would otherwise build by hand. Where it stands on 15 September 2026.

85% of our archive builds every rule tested

WHAT IT DOES, IN PLAIN TERMS

Drop in a structural drawing set — the PDF we already send the client — and out comes an ETABS model with the building typed in: every storey at its elevation, the grid, the columns sized and turned as drawn, the walls at their true thickness, the floor plates, the openings. No Revit, no re-drawing, no typing. The engineer opens it and starts engineering — the part only an engineer can do. When Andrea first saw it: *"if I have that, it's going to take me like no time to rebuild it."*

WHERE IT STANDS — MEASURED ON OUR OWN DRAWINGS, NOT ESTIMATED

BREADTH

253 of our 296 jobs

Every current structural set in our archive goes through the tool after every change — 8,650 pages in under an hour. 253 build a model from the PDF alone; the 43 that don't say exactly why (17 are just copies of another job's file).

ACCURACY

Where the engineer put it

Checked against the engineers' own ETABS models: on jobs with a current model, about two of every three columns land within 100 mm of where the engineer put theirs — and often it is their model that has moved on. Storeys, grids and walls read straight off the sheet.

TRUST

It says what it assumed

Every reading rule is code with a test, or a row in our standards database (86 of them). Anything the tool had to assume is listed in the report beside the model. An independent AI reviewer has audited the logic four times; the last audit's findings were fixed the same day.

THE BAR THE ENGINEERS SET — IN THEIR OWN WORDS

What "usable" means

"As long as I have the vertical and overall the shape of the slab, it's good enough for me to start." — the columns and walls on every storey, plus the outline of each floor. One model per building. The engineering stays with the engineer.

Where we are

Columns and walls: on every storey of every job that builds. Floor outlines: four storeys in ten today — closing that is the next two weeks, the difference between "a good start" and "ready to run".

Already settled by their answers

Footings aren't modelled; basement and retaining walls are; beams aren't (headers are); each level appears once; one file per building. Each of those is now a rule the tool follows — nobody gets asked twice.

NEXT TWO WEEKS

1. A floor outline on every storey — the engineers' own bar.
2. Two rules straight from their answers: footings are not columns; a part plan never duplicates the overall plan.
3. The remaining 26 jobs that could build and don't, each with its cause named.

THEN

Models for three live jobs — one per building, as the engineers asked — dropped into the job folders for review. What the engineers say becomes the next rules, exactly as Andrea's answers already have.

The only ask, then: an hour with the model open.

WHY I'M EXCITED

Nobody else in our market has this.

It removes the typing, never the engineering. And once it reads a set, a reissue becomes a diff — "here is what changed" — instead of a rebuild. No vendor can sell it: it is built from our conventions and our engineers' rules.